A Retrieval-Augmented Chatbot for Philippine Consumer-Rights Questions About Online Purchases

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GROUP PURPLE R

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ITCC508 — WW-M2 Group Proposal · Jose Rizal University

JRU RESEARCH AGENDA:

THE REAL PROBLEM

Three parties state the rules. Only one is the law.

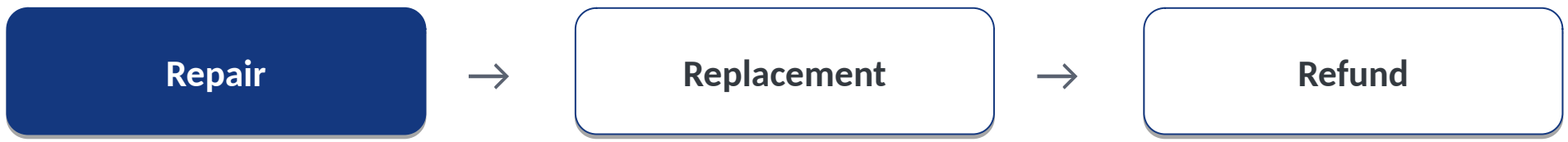
The seller posts “No Return, No Exchange” — a policy the Consumer Act prohibits.

The platform sets a refund window — a commercial term, not a legal right.

The statute grants repair, replacement and refund — and almost nobody has read it.

The buyer decides what to do using the least authoritative of the three.

SDG 12 — Targets 12.8 and 12.5



The Consumer Act grants three remedies in that order. That ordering is the waste hierarchy written as a legal entitlement.

A buyer who knows repair can be demanded keeps the item. A buyer who does not know throws it away and buys another.

The information gap has an output measured in discarded goods.

TASK 2 — NARROWING

From a broad domain to one information need

Consumer protection

SDG 12 · 12.8 + 12.5

Filipino online shoppers

Which remedy am I legally owed for this defective order?

Not “consumer rights.” Short questions with a statutory answer:

Is that posted policy lawful? Which of the three remedies applies? What does not qualify? Where do I file?

TASK 3 — RESEARCH QUESTION

One question, with a baseline

To what extent does retrieval grounding improve the correctness and groundedness of answers to Philippine consumer-rights questions about online purchases, compared with a non-RAG baseline using the same language model?

Same questions. Same model. Retrieval on, retrieval off.

Holding the model constant is what makes any difference attributable to retrieval.

The model has absorbed American and European consumer law. If the baseline offers the EU's 14-day right to change your mind — which does not exist here — that is a hallucination we can score without argument.

TASK 4 — DATA

Where the data will come from

KNOWLEDGE BASE — ALL PUBLIC

RA 7394, Consumer Act of the Philippines

RA 8792, Electronic Commerce Act

DTI Fair Trade Bureau consumer FAQ

DTI advisories and complaint procedure

EVALUATION SET

Questions collected from classmates, not invented

Each mapped to its supporting statutory passage

Two members map independently, the third reconciles

One in five about platform policy, not law — genuinely unanswerable

No permission needed from anyone. Nothing has been collected yet.

TASK 5 — MODEL & REFLECTION

A model we can access, a scope we can finish

openai/gpt-oss-20b via the Groq API — free tier, no local GPU, fast.

Follows prompt constraints reliably — the property groundedness depends on.

A reader, not a legal authority: any rule not in the retrieved passage is a failure, even if true elsewhere.

Three members, three roles: corpus curation, test-set construction, evaluation scoring.

What we are deliberately not doing: no legal advice · no platform evaluated · no claim about real consumer outcomes · no jurisdiction outside the Philippines.